

quit the organization due to this reason and worked towards its wider adoption once it was open sourced. However, they were rehired later and the ban was lifted as well. As of today, it has a thriving community which actively develops it for numerous production applications.

The name for this language is ostensibly inspired from the unit with the same name, which was used to measure the load on telecommunication switches and other devices. Originally, its usage was obviously restricted mostly to telcoms systems, but today it works under the hood for many large scale distributed systems.



Joe Armstrong, the co-founder of Erlang

While, it may not be as ubiquitous in the wider technology sector as are other languages like C or Java, its relevance grows day by day as our systems grow more and more complex and distributed at the same time. It's also getting more and more dominant because of the increasing focus and availability of multicore processors, which makes concurrency and multiprocessing even more important. Erlang's usage has been more than dominant in developing modern software which are used in systems like chatting, commenting, managing transactional data and networking devices.

The success of Erlang in modern distributed systems has been largely untold, despite the fact that companies like Facebook, Whatsapp, Amazon, Rackspace etc., along with popular open source software like RabbitMQ and CouchDB actively use it as part of the underlying stack in their software. It's also used as part of the Disco MapReduce framework and the YAWS web server.



Riak is a NoSQL database that uses Erlang



CouchDB is a NoSQL document store that has been developed in Erlang